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UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP
COLLEGES OF EDUCATION
END OF SEMESTER ONE EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 300, 2024/2025
B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: TEJS 313
COURSE TITLE: SOCIOLINGUISTICS

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.

Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

[25 Marks]

Answer **all** the questions in this section.

1. Which of the following concepts best defines sociolinguistics?
   A. The study of syntax and phonetics only
   B. The study of language as a system of rules
   C. The study of how language varies and changes in social groups
   D. The study of ancient languages

2. A sociolinguistic approach that focuses on the systematic observation of language use in real-life contexts is known as_____.
   A. Descriptive approach
   B. Ethnographic approach
   C. Theoretical approach

3. Which of the following options **best** explains the relationship between language and society?
   A. Language is unaffected by social norms.
   B. Society changes to fit language rules.
   C. Language both shapes and is shaped by social context.
   D. Language operates independently of society.

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4. Two speech varieties that are mutually intelligible are typically considered_____.
   A. Creoles
   B. Dialects
   C. Lingua franca
   D. Registers

5. A teacher in a multilingual classroom frequently alternates between English and the dominant local language when explaining abstract scientific terms. What pedagogical advantage does this code-switching approach offer?
   A. It promotes strict adherence to curriculum language policy.
   B. It prevents interference between the languages being used.
   C. It facilitates comprehension by bridging linguistic gaps in understanding.
   D. It reinforces students' use of academic English exclusively.

6. Which of these options best describes intersecting language communities?
   A. Communities that do not share any linguistic features
   B. Communities that share a single mother tongue
   C. Communities with overlapping linguistic practices
   D. Communities with only written communication

7. One key feature of a multilingual community is_____.
   A. One language dominates all aspects of life
   B. Languages are used interchangeably in all contexts without rules
   C. Individuals can switch languages depending on context and interlocutor
   D. Language use is rigid and assigned by age

8. Which of the following options is a sign of code-switching in conversation?
   A. Speaking in monotone
   B. Alternating between languages or dialects in different situations
   C. Mispronouncing a word
   D. Using sign language only

9. Which of the following option is a by-product of multilingualism?
   A. Monolingual education policies
   B. Nationalistic movements
   C. Code-switching and hybrid language forms
   D. Elimination of local cultures

10. When two people speak different dialects but understand each other easily, their varieties are said to be_____.
   A. Codified
   B. Comprehensible
   C. Mutually intelligible
   D. Phonetically distinct

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11. Which of the following options typically occurs in a diglossic community?
    A. Both languages used have equal prestige
    B. One variety is used in formal domains and another in informal ones
    C. Code-switching is discouraged
    D. The low variety replaces the high variety

12. Why might a language undergo shift in a multilingual society?
    A. Due to lack of orthography
    B. Due to influence from more socially or economically powerful languages
    C. Due to climate change
    D. Due to rapid population growth

13. Language death is most likely to occur when_____.
    A. There is increased intergenerational transmission
    B. A community actively uses its native tongue in school
    C. The younger generation no longer learns or uses the language
    D. The community rather focuses on faming

14. Creole languages usually develop when_____.
    A. Two dialects merge over time
    B. A pidgin becomes the first language of a community
    C. A language is used only in writing
    D. A standard variety is codified

15. A speaker who shifts between formal and informal speech depending on context is demonstrating awareness of_____.
    A. Syntax rules
    B. Speech acts
    C. Pragmatic relevance
    D. Register

16. The term 'idiolect' refers to_____.
    A. A dialect used in rural communities
    B. A language without grammar
    C. An individual's unique speech pattern
    D. The speech style of a particular region

17. In sociolinguistics, which of these factors most influences language variation?
    A. Governments' policies
    B. Geographic mobility
    C. Orthographic policies
    D. National borders

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18. Which of these options **best** shows language and social identity intersecting?
    A. Speaking English only at home
    B. Using a prestige accent to gain social mobility
    C. Avoiding conversation
    D. Reading silently in a library

19. Positive politeness strategies are used to_____.
    A. Insult a conversation partner
    B. Maintain formal distance
    C. Show friendliness and inclusion
    D. Avoid using language altogether

20. Which of the following options best illustrates sexist language?
    A. Using gender-neutral job titles
    B. Referring to all doctors as "he"
    C. Including both male and female pronouns
    D. Avoiding gender references

21. Which of the following statements aligns with the dominance approach to language and gender?
    A. Gendered language differences are due to power imbalance in society
    B. Men and women speak exactly the same
    C. Differences in speech are due to biological differences
    D. All language is gender-neutral

22. Language planning in multilingual countries aims to_____.
    A. Reduce language to a single form
    B. Promote only indigenous languages
    C. Manage language use for communication and development
    D. Eliminate minority languages

23. One feature of national language planning is_____.
    A. Encouraging a private language
    B. Choosing a language for national unity
    C. Reducing bilingual education
    D. Promoting endangered dialects only

24. Which of these options is a common reason for variation across regional dialects?
    A. Standard language enforcement
    B. Media homogenization
    C. Historical migration patterns
    D. Lack of communication

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25. Ghana's language-in-education policy recommends the use of a Ghanaian language as the medium of instruction in early primary education. Which of the following statements presents a **key** implementation challenge of this policy?
A. Students are unwilling to speak their home language in class
B. All teachers prefer to use English for all levels of instruction
C. There is a lack of adequate teaching and learning materials in many local languages
D. The policy only applies to urban schools with high enrolment

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SECTION B

[75 Marks]

Answer any **three** questions in this section.

1. a. What is sociolinguistics? [5Marks]
   b. Explain three (3) ways sociolinguistic principles be applied to enhance understanding of language use among students? [10 Marks]
   c. Discuss two (2) challenges that teachers face when incorporating sociolinguistic awareness in their teaching? [10 Marks]

2. a. What is multilingualism? [5Marks]

   b. Explain three (3) ways multilingualism influences language acquisition among students. [10 Marks]

   c. Discuss two (2) ways by which teachers can leverage on students' multilingual backgrounds to enhance learning outcomes. [10 Marks]

3. What is code-switching/code-mixing? [5Marks]
   a. Explain two (2) potential benefits and drawbacks of these practices for language learners. [10 Marks]

   b. Discuss two (2) ways teachers can effectively manage code-switching/code-mixing to support language development. [10 Marks]

4. a. What is politeness? [5Marks]
   b. Explain three (3) ways by which politeness influences student-teacher relationships. [5Marks]
   c. In what ways can awareness of politeness strategies improve classroom communication? Support your argument with two (2) points. [10 Marks]

5. a. What is the relationship between language and gender? [5 Marks]

   b. Explain three (3) ways by which language choices reflect gender dynamics in the classroom? [10 Marks]

   c. What role does teacher awareness of gendered language play in creating an inclusive classroom environment? Support your argument with three (2) points. [10 Marks]